

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Insurance English

Learner workbook

Work with realistic cases, develop your own response, and use the answer section after you have tried the tasks.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Find the right language. Speak, write, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For underwriters, claims adjusters, brokers, risk managers, actuarial analysts, policy-service teams, compliance staff, and insurance operations leaders.

Fictional language practice. Legal, financial, and regulatory meanings depend on jurisdiction and context; use current documents and qualified review for actual decisions.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Your course at a glance

Use the lesson numbers to match this document with the website and the other guides.

01 Underwriting and Risk Selection

Clarify missing information before responding.

02 Policy Language and Coverage Interpretation

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

03 Claims Intake and Reserving

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

04 Coverage Disputes and Denials

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

05 Broker and Client Renewal Meetings

Compare options using the same criteria and state the tradeoff.

06 Fraud Indicators and SIU Referral

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

07 Actuarial Assumptions and Pricing

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

08 Compliance, Market Conduct, and Complaints

Acknowledge a communication problem and give a corrected message.

Choose your pace

Quick practice: spend 15 minutes reading one case and saying a response. Full lesson: allow 45-60 minutes for language work, conversation, writing, and revision.

Level support

B1 learners can use the frames and a partner. B2 learners can try a response before reading the model. C1 learners can add the harder follow-up and reduce preparation time. These are teaching suggestions, not certified CEFR level ratings.

LESSON 01 / READ AND NOTICE

Underwriting and Risk Selection

Clarify missing information before responding.

SITUATION

An underwriting submission describes a business activity broadly but omits its operating locations and loss history.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

underwriting - Evaluation of risk and terms used to decide whether and on what conditions to issue insurance, extend credit, or accept an investment exposure.

risk appetite - The amount and types of risk an organization is prepared to pursue or retain.

exposure - The extent to which people, assets, or operations are subject to a hazard or potential loss.

loss history - A record of prior claims or losses for an insured risk.

3. Notice the language

Name the exact word, fact, or requirement you need clarified. Ask one focused question at a time. Repeat your understanding and give the other person a chance to correct it.

When you say ..., do you mean ...?

Could you clarify which ...?

So, my understanding is Is that right?

Improve this sentence: Could you explain what does this mean?

LESSON 01 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Ask a precise question

4. Check the language

1. Which indirect question has the usual word order?
 - A. Could you confirm when the review starts?
 - B. Could you confirm when does the review start?
 - C. Could you confirm when starts the review?
2. Someone says the report is 'ready.' Which question best clarifies its approval status?
 - A. Can you send the report to me this afternoon?
 - B. Who will present the report at the meeting?
 - C. Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review?

5. Say it

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

6. Write it

Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

After checking the answer section, revise one sentence and try the spoken response again.

LESSON 02 / READ AND NOTICE

Policy Language and Coverage Interpretation

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

SITUATION

A client sees a policy summary and assumes it includes every term of coverage. The full policy has endorsements and exclusions.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

policy - Formal rule or standard that guides decisions and behavior.

endorsement - A document that changes an insurance policy's terms.

exclusion - Something outside an agreed scope or expressly not covered by a policy or agreement.

coverage - The protection provided by an insurance policy; in telecommunications, the area with service availability.

3. Notice the language

Start with the reader's question. Explain one unfamiliar term with familiar words, then give a relevant example or contrast. Check understanding without asking only 'Do you understand?'.

In this context, ... means

The difference is that

How would you explain that distinction to a colleague?

Improve this sentence: We need to operationalize the implementation.

LESSON 02 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Make a complex point clear

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence explains 'backlog' rather than repeating it?
 - A. The backlog is an important operational backlog.
 - B. The backlog must be reviewed at the backlog meeting.
 - C. The backlog is the work still waiting to be completed.
2. Which follow-up best checks whether your explanation was clear?
 - A. You understand everything now, don't you?
 - B. How would you describe the next step in your own words?
 - C. I have explained the next step, so shall we finish?

5. Say it

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are unfamiliar with one technical term in the case. Ask for a plain-English explanation and then paraphrase it. Do not pretend to understand a term you cannot explain.

6. Write it

Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

After checking the answer section, revise one sentence and try the spoken response again.

LESSON 03 / READ AND NOTICE

Claims Intake and Reserving

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

SITUATION

A claim report lacks the event date and supporting documents. The intake team needs a clear follow-up request.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

claim - A statement that may need evidence, approval, qualification, or disclosure before it is used externally.

reserve - Resources set aside for a purpose; in insurance, an estimate of amounts needed for obligations.

proof of loss - Information or a formal statement supporting an insurance loss claim as required by the process.

adjuster - A person who investigates and evaluates an insurance claim.

3. Notice the language

State the action and the information needed. Explain why it matters and specify a deadline only when one is given or agreed. 'Could you' is polite; repeated apologies can obscure a legitimate request. Urgent situations may require a direct request.

Could you provide ... so that ...?

Please confirm ... by [agreed time].

If that timing is not possible, please let me know

Improve this sentence: Please revert soonest with the necessary.

LESSON 03 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Ask for an actionable next step

4. Check the language

1. What does 'Please send it by Thursday' normally mean?
 - A. Send it on a date later than Thursday.
 - B. Send it no later than Thursday.
 - C. Send it only after Thursday.
2. Which request gives the recipient enough detail to act?
 - A. Could you confirm the document version needed for the review?
 - B. Could you deal with the relevant matters soon?
 - C. Could you do the needful for the situation?

5. Say it

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You can help but need a clear request and its purpose. Ask what is required and whether the timing is fixed or negotiable.

6. Write it

Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

After checking the answer section, revise one sentence and try the spoken response again.

LESSON 04 / READ AND NOTICE

Coverage Disputes and Denials

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

SITUATION

A client asks whether a reported loss is definitely covered. The claim review is still underway.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

denial - Decision by an insurer, payer, regulator, or authority not to approve, pay, or grant a requested item or claim.

reservation of rights - An insurer's notice preserving specified coverage positions while a matter is reviewed, subject to applicable law.

appeal - A request for a decision to be reviewed through an established process.

coverage position - An insurer's stated interpretation of how policy coverage applies to a claim.

3. Notice the language

Say what the evidence shows, identify what is still unknown, and limit the conclusion to that evidence. Words such as 'may', 'suggests', and 'in this sample' are useful when the uncertainty is real. Do not soften an urgent, verified safety concern.

The available evidence shows

This may indicate ..., but

We have not yet established whether

Improve this sentence: The pilot proves this will work everywhere.

LESSON 04 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Match certainty to evidence

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence preserves uncertainty about an unconfirmed cause?
 - A. The change may have contributed to the delay.
 - B. The change must have caused the delay.
 - C. The change definitely caused the delay.
2. A result comes from a small pilot in one location. Which phrase accurately limits the claim?
 - A. In every location, the result will be ...
 - B. Without any uncertainty, the result is ...
 - C. In this pilot, the observed result was ...

5. Say it

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

6. Write it

Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

After checking the answer section, revise one sentence and try the spoken response again.

LESSON 05 / READ AND NOTICE

Broker and Client Renewal Meetings

Compare options using the same criteria and state the tradeoff.

SITUATION

A renewal quote has a lower premium but a higher deductible. The client asks whether it is the same protection for less money.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

renewal - Continuation of a policy, contract, or subscription for a further period.

premium - The price charged for insurance coverage over a stated period.

deductible - The amount a policyholder bears before the insurer pays covered amounts as the policy specifies.

reinsurance - Insurance purchased by an insurer to transfer an agreed part of its risk.

3. Notice the language

Use the same time period, scope, and measurement basis for both options. Explain a difference with 'whereas' or 'while'. State what improves and what is given up; do not hide the weaker side of a recommendation.

Both options ..., but

Option A ..., whereas option B

The comparison depends on

Improve this sentence: This option is more better.

LESSON 05 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Explain a fair comparison

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence expresses a clear contrast?
 - A. Option A is faster because option B costs less.
 - B. Option A is faster, so option B costs less.
 - C. Option A is faster, whereas option B costs less.
2. A rate increases from 6% to 7%. What is the absolute difference?
 - A. An increase of seven percentage points.
 - B. An increase of one percentage point.
 - C. An increase of one percent relative to the original rate.

5. Say it

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You favor one option but have not checked whether the scope is comparable. Ask about one difference, then explain the tradeoff you are willing to accept.

6. Write it

Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

After checking the answer section, revise one sentence and try the spoken response again.

LESSON 06 / READ AND NOTICE

Fraud Indicators and SIU Referral

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

SITUATION

An unusual claim pattern prompts concern. A note calls the customer fraudulent before an investigation has established the facts.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

fraud indicator - An observation that may warrant investigation but does not by itself prove fraud.

SIU - Special investigation unit: an insurance team examining claims or concerns that need specialist investigation.

material misrepresentation - A false or misleading statement significant to a decision under applicable law or contract terms.

investigation - A systematic effort to establish facts and understand an event or concern.

3. Notice the language

Say what the evidence shows, identify what is still unknown, and limit the conclusion to that evidence. Words such as 'may', 'suggests', and 'in this sample' are useful when the uncertainty is real. Do not soften an urgent, verified safety concern.

The available evidence shows

This may indicate ..., but

We have not yet established whether

Improve this sentence: The pilot proves this will work everywhere.

LESSON 06 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Match certainty to evidence

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence preserves uncertainty about an unconfirmed cause?
 - A. The change definitely caused the delay.
 - B. The change may have contributed to the delay.
 - C. The change must have caused the delay.
2. A result comes from a small pilot in one location. Which phrase accurately limits the claim?
 - A. In this pilot, the observed result was ...
 - B. In every location, the result will be ...
 - C. Without any uncertainty, the result is ...

5. Say it

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

6. Write it

Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

After checking the answer section, revise one sentence and try the spoken response again.

LESSON 07 / READ AND NOTICE

Actuarial Assumptions and Pricing

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

SITUATION

An actuarial update shows claim costs rising because both the number of claims and average cost per claim increased.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

loss development - Changes in estimated or reported insurance losses as more information becomes available over time.

frequency - How often an event occurs within a stated population or period.

severity - The seriousness of an event, impact, or loss under stated criteria.

reserve adequacy - Whether estimated insurance reserves are sufficient for the obligations they are intended to cover.

3. Notice the language

Start with the reader's question. Explain one unfamiliar term with familiar words, then give a relevant example or contrast. Check understanding without asking only 'Do you understand?'.

In this context, ... means

The difference is that

How would you explain that distinction to a colleague?

Improve this sentence: We need to operationalize the implementation.

LESSON 07 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Make a complex point clear

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence explains 'backlog' rather than repeating it?
 - A. The backlog is the work still waiting to be completed.
 - B. The backlog is an important operational backlog.
 - C. The backlog must be reviewed at the backlog meeting.
2. Which follow-up best checks whether your explanation was clear?
 - A. I have explained the next step, so shall we finish?
 - B. You understand everything now, don't you?
 - C. How would you describe the next step in your own words?

5. Say it

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are unfamiliar with one technical term in the case. Ask for a plain-English explanation and then paraphrase it. Do not pretend to understand a term you cannot explain.

6. Write it

Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

After checking the answer section, revise one sentence and try the spoken response again.

LESSON 08 / READ AND NOTICE

Compliance, Market Conduct, and Complaints

Acknowledge a communication problem and give a corrected message.

SITUATION

A policyholder's complaint received a generic reply that did not address a specific fee question.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

market conduct - How an insurer or financial firm treats customers and carries out market-facing activities.

complaint - An expression of dissatisfaction requiring attention under a relevant process.

timely communication - Providing information early enough to meet the relevant need or required process.

corrective action - Action taken to fix a current problem and prevent recurrence.

3. Notice the language

Name what was unclear or wrong, acknowledge its effect, and correct it. A brief apology can help, followed by a practical next step. Avoid explaining away the other person's reaction or promising an outcome you cannot control.

My earlier message did not make ... clear.

I'm sorry for The correct information is

Let me check that the revised explanation addresses

Improve this sentence: I'm sorry if you failed to understand.

LESSON 08 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Repair a misunderstanding

4. Check the language

1. Which apology takes responsibility for unclear wording?

- A. I'm sorry you did not read it correctly.
- B. I'm sorry if you chose to misunderstand it.
- C. I'm sorry my earlier wording was unclear.

2. What should follow an apology for an incorrect date?

- A. A new guaranteed date even if it is unverified.
- B. The corrected date and the current confirmation status.
- C. A longer explanation that never states the correct date.

5. Say it

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are frustrated because an earlier message created an expectation. Explain that expectation. Ask your partner to distinguish the correction from anything still uncertain.

6. Write it

Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

After checking the answer section, revise one sentence and try the spoken response again.

Answer workshop

Try the tasks first. The model is one acceptable response, not a script to memorize. Your written version needs a subject line, an opening, and appropriate context. Assess it using the four criteria at the end.

01 | Underwriting and Risk Selection

Editing example: Could you explain what this means?

After an introductory phrase such as 'Could you explain', the embedded question uses statement word order: what this means.

Check 1: A - Could you confirm when the review starts?

A: The embedded question uses subject then verb: the review starts.

B: Remove 'does' and use statement word order after 'confirm'.

C: Place the subject 'the review' before 'starts'.

Check 2: C - Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review?

A: This asks about delivery timing, not whether approval has happened.

B: This asks about the presenter, not the report's approval status.

C: This question distinguishes two meanings of 'ready' that affect the next action.

Model response: Could you confirm the activities, locations, and requested loss-history information? Those details will help the underwriting team assess the submission without relying on assumptions about the business.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

02 | Policy Language and Coverage Interpretation

Editing example: We need to put the plan into practice.

The revised sentence names the action in familiar words. Specialist vocabulary is useful when it adds precision, but repeating abstract nouns can hide the meaning.

Check 1: C - The backlog is the work still waiting to be completed.

A: Repeating the same term does not define it.

B: This describes a meeting but leaves the term unexplained.

C: This gives the meaning in familiar words.

Check 2: B - How would you describe the next step in your own words?

A: This leading question makes it easy to agree without showing understanding.

B: An open request lets the listener show their understanding.

C: Finishing the conversation gives no evidence of understanding.

Model response: The summary is an overview. The actual policy wording, including endorsements and exclusions, needs to be reviewed for the coverage question. Let's identify the relevant documents and ask the appropriate specialist to clarify them.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

03 | Claims Intake and Reserving

Editing example: Could you send the missing document and confirm when it will be available?

The revision names the document and requested response. It avoids expressions that may be unfamiliar or ambiguous for an international audience.

Check 1: B - Send it no later than Thursday.

A: A later date does not meet a 'by Thursday' deadline.

B: 'By' sets the latest point, while 'after' refers to a later time.

C: This reverses the meaning of the deadline.

Check 2: A - Could you confirm the document version needed for the review?

A: The requested action and information are explicit.

B: 'Relevant matters' and 'soon' leave the task unclear.

C: This expression does not identify the specific action needed.

Model response: Could you provide the event date and the requested supporting records through the secure channel? If an item is unavailable, please tell us so the claim team can explain the next step.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

04 | Coverage Disputes and Denials

Editing example: The pilot worked in the tested setting; performance elsewhere remains untested.

The revision states the finding and its scope. It avoids turning limited evidence into a universal claim.

Check 1: A - The change may have contributed to the delay.

A: 'May have contributed' presents a possibility without claiming the cause is established.

B: 'Must have' expresses a strong inference that the evidence may not support.

C: 'Definitely' presents the cause as certain.

Check 2: C - In this pilot, the observed result was ...

A: The pilot does not establish future results everywhere.

B: This removes uncertainty rather than explaining its limits.

C: This locates the finding in the setting actually studied.

Model response: The coverage review is still underway, so I cannot confirm the outcome. I can explain what information has been received, what remains outstanding, and how the team will communicate its decision.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

05 | Broker and Client Renewal Meetings

Editing example: This option is better on cost, but slower to deliver.

'Better' already has comparative meaning, so it does not need 'more'. Naming the criterion and tradeoff makes the comparison useful.

Check 1: C - Option A is faster, whereas option B costs less.

A: 'Because' claims a causal connection that is not given.

B: 'So' implies one fact causes the other.

C: 'Whereas' marks a contrast between two options.

Check 2: B - An increase of one percentage point.

A: The new rate is 7%; the difference between the rates is one percentage point.

B: Subtracting 6% from 7% gives one percentage point. The relative increase is about 16.7%.

C: A one-percent relative increase on 6% would be 6.06%, not 7%.

Model response: The premium is lower, but the deductible has changed. We should compare the coverage terms and other differences as well before describing the options as equivalent.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

06 | Fraud Indicators and SIU Referral

Editing example: The pilot worked in the tested setting; performance elsewhere remains untested.

The revision states the finding and its scope. It avoids turning limited evidence into a universal claim.

Check 1: B - The change may have contributed to the delay.

A: 'Definitely' presents the cause as certain.

B: 'May have contributed' presents a possibility without claiming the cause is established.

C: 'Must have' expresses a strong inference that the evidence may not support.

Check 2: A - In this pilot, the observed result was ...

A: This locates the finding in the setting actually studied.

B: The pilot does not establish future results everywhere.

C: This removes uncertainty rather than explaining its limits.

Model response: The pattern is an indicator for review, not proof of fraud. I'll describe the observed facts neutrally and route the concern through the appropriate investigation process.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

07 | Actuarial Assumptions and Pricing

Editing example: We need to put the plan into practice.

The revised sentence names the action in familiar words. Specialist vocabulary is useful when it adds precision, but repeating abstract nouns can hide the meaning.

Check 1: A - The backlog is the work still waiting to be completed.

A: This gives the meaning in familiar words.

B: Repeating the same term does not define it.

C: This describes a meeting but leaves the term unexplained.

Check 2: C - How would you describe the next step in your own words?

A: Finishing the conversation gives no evidence of understanding.

B: This leading question makes it easy to agree without showing understanding.

C: An open request lets the listener show their understanding.

Model response: Both frequency and severity contributed to the increase. I'll show the number of claims separately from their average cost so the audience can understand the two drivers.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

08 | Compliance, Market Conduct, and Complaints

Editing example: I'm sorry my message did not explain the timing clearly.

The revision takes responsibility for the message without blaming the listener. It identifies what needs to be corrected.

Check 1: C - I'm sorry my earlier wording was unclear.

A: This shifts blame to the reader.

B: This attributes an unverified motive to the listener.

C: This acknowledges the speaker's contribution to the problem.

Check 2: B - The corrected date and the current confirmation status.

A: An unsupported new promise can create a second misunderstanding.

B: A repair needs usable corrected information, including any uncertainty.

C: The reader still lacks the information they need.

Model response: Our earlier reply did not answer your fee question. I'm sorry. I'll record that point for review and explain the next step and expected update under our complaints process.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and writes a 70-110 word message. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

Fictional language practice. Legal, financial, and regulatory meanings depend on jurisdiction and context; use current documents and qualified review for actual decisions.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.